CHECKLIST · 12 POINTS

The 12-Point AI Rollout Checklist

For owners and operators who sell their own expertise. Work through it before you roll AI out to yourself or your team, so the time you save is real and the risks are handled up front.

01 · BEFORE YOU START

- [ ] **01 Name the outcome in hours or dollars.**
  Write one sentence: what should be different in 90 days? For example, “proposals take half the time” or “Friday reporting is off my plate.” If you can’t name it, you’re not ready to buy a tool.

- [ ] **02 Map one week of real work.**
  List every recurring task and how long it takes. Mark each one as mechanical (you already know the answer) or judgment (you’re making a call). Start AI on the mechanical ones.

- [ ] **03 Pick one task to go first.**
  Choose something frequent, low risk, and annoying. One task done well beats ten done halfway.

02 · SET UP THE FOUNDATION

- [ ] **04 Decide what client information can go in.**
  Write down what’s allowed, what’s never allowed, and what needs anonymizing first. Check your client contracts and any professional rules that apply to you.

- [ ] **05 Choose the tool and the account type on purpose.**
  Use a business plan with data controls, not personal accounts. Confirm whether your data is used for training and turn that off where you can.

- [ ] **06 Build your context once.**
  Write a short file that explains your business, your clients, your voice, and your standards. Load it every time so you stop re-explaining yourself every Monday.

- [ ] **07 Write a simple usage policy.**
  One page: approved tools, what data is allowed, who reviews output, and what gets disclosed to clients. Make sure everyone on the team has read it.

03 · ROLL IT OUT

08 **Keep a human check on anything that leaves the building.** ☐

Every client-facing output gets reviewed by a person who could have done the work themselves. Verify facts, numbers, and citations at the source.

09 **Protect the reps that keep you sharp.** ☐

List the three or four judgment tasks you will keep doing yourself, on purpose. Automate the assembly, not the thinking clients pay for.

10 **Train people on the task, not the tool.** ☐

Show each person how to do their actual recurring work with AI, using your context file. Generic prompt training rarely sticks.

04 · MAKE IT STICK

11 **Measure before and after.** ☐

Time the chosen task for two weeks before and two weeks after. If the hours didn't come back, find out why before expanding.

12 **Review monthly and expand one task at a time.** ☐

Each month, ask what worked, what broke, and what's next. Add the next task only once the last one is stable.

NEXT STEP

Want help working through this for your business?

Book an AI Assessment and leave with a clear plan for your first tasks, your rules, and your rollout.
meetings-na2.hubspot.com/rwalrath/ai-assessment

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